CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

SENIOR HOME CARE AGENCY OWNER IN THE AI ERA

Families pay for trustworthy care at home — the agency that staffs it well never lacks clients or headaches.

★ TL;DR — Around $110K a year as an agency owner, with the business built over 6–12 months. The catch: this is a staffing business in a licensed, regulated space — your real product is reliable caregivers. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

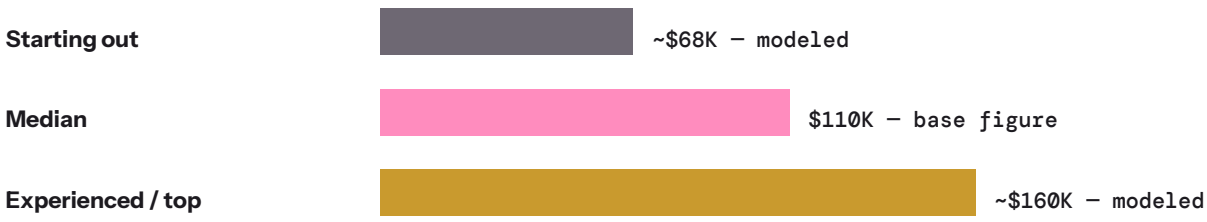
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$110K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- Demand is personal and recurring: once a family trusts your aides, the hours continue for months or years.
- The money is made in the spread between what families pay and what caregivers earn — scheduling discipline is profit.
- Every state regulates home care differently; the agency license and rules are step one, not paperwork for later.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Senior Home Care Agency Owner is a ~$110K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around

any number.

WHAT DOES A SENIOR HOME CARE AGENCY OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Recruit, screen, hire and retain home care aides
- ✓ Match caregivers to clients and fill shifts — including the 6 a.m. call-outs
- ✓ Sell to families and referral sources: hospitals, rehab centers, elder-law offices
- ✓ Handle care plans, documentation, billing and compliance

Think: a matchmaking agency where a bad match is not a bad date — it is a vulnerable senior left alone.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI is absorbing scheduling suggestions, intake calls, note summaries and billing admin. Software flags missed clock-ins and predicts which shifts are likely to be called out.	Trust stays human. A daughter handing you her mother's house keys, a caregiver calming a confused client at midnight — hiring for character and showing up when care fails is the whole business.

⚠ **Caregiver shortages and call-outs will run your life until your bench is deep. One bad hire can cost a client, a reputation, or worse — screening is not a formality here.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Work that visibly matters to real families ✓ Recurring private-pay revenue, no insurance billing required in the non-medical lane ✓ Scales by hiring — your tenth caregiver costs a job ad, not a building	✗ The phone rings when care falls apart — evenings and weekends included ✗ Constant hiring: aide turnover is the industry's weather ✗ Regulated paperwork and liability ride along with every case

Good fit? An organized people-person who can recruit relentlessly, stay calm at 6 a.m. crises and sell trust to worried families.
Bad fit? You want a hands-off asset. An agency runs on your judgment about people, daily.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — START INDEPENDENT	DOOR B — BUY A FRANCHISE

The lean route: get your state's home care agency license (requirements vary widely by state — some license non-medical agencies, some barely regulate them), set up insurance, policies and caregiver screening, then sign your first families directly.	National home care franchises sell the brand, training and systems for an upfront fee plus royalties. You still do the hiring and the selling — what you buy is a playbook and a recognized name, not clients.

Smart move: Win one referral source deeply instead of ten shallowly: a single hospital discharge planner or elder-law attorney who trusts you can feed the agency for years.
Where you land after: A multi-team agency with an office manager running scheduling — then a second territory or a sale to a regional operator.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
MAP YOUR	BUILD THE	HIRE BEFORE	SET PRICING	SELL TRUST,	RUN THE

STEP 1 — Map your state's rules first

FREE · 2-4 WEEKS

- Find out exactly how your state licenses non-medical home care agencies and what it requires: administrator qualifications, background checks, insurance, fees.
- Decide your lane: non-medical care (companionship, personal care, dementia support) is the standard private-pay entry.

STEP 2 — Build the business shell

$500-3,000 · 1-2 MONTHS

- Apply for the agency license where required, register the business, bind liability and bonding insurance.
- Write the unglamorous core: care agreements, employee handbook, screening and documentation procedures.

STEP 3 — Hire before you sell

$200-800 · 1 MONTH

- Recruit your first bench of caregivers before the first client signs — families buy reliability, and you cannot fake a bench.
- Screen like it matters: references, background checks, and a paid working interview shift.

STEP 4 — Set pricing and systems

$100-400/MO · 2 WEEKS

- Set hourly rates and minimums from real local numbers; know your margin per hour after wages, taxes and insurance.
- Put scheduling, clock-in and billing software in place before client number three, not after client number thirty.

STEP 5 — Sell trust, locally

$0-500 · ONGOING

- Visit referral sources in person: discharge planners, rehab facilities, elder-law and estate attorneys, senior centers.
- Offer free in-home assessments — the kitchen-table conversation is where this business is won.

STEP 6 — Run the bench like a roster

PAID · ONGOING

- Keep hiring ahead of demand; a waitlist of caregivers is cheaper than a cancelled shift.
- Review cases weekly: which families are thrilled, which aides are burning out, where the next call-out will hurt most.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: read your state's home care agency licensing rules end to end and write the checklist.
- □ Days 1–30: file the license application where required, set up the business, insurance and core documents.
- □ Days 31–60: recruit and screen your first caregiver bench; put scheduling and billing systems live.
- □ Days 61–90: work referral sources in person and sign your first private-pay families.
- □ Day 90: a licensed, staffed agency with first cases running — growth is now a hiring-and-referrals rhythm.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **TRUST IS THE PRODUCT. CARE IS THE PROOF.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.